

Response to the Parliamentary Accounts and Works
Committee Inquiry into Data Centres

Protocol Policy Lab

[Zac Kienzle](#)

May 17, 2026

Abstract

Start this section on a new page. The abstract should state the inquiry the submission addresses, the scope of the Protocol Policy Lab response, the evidence base, and the headline findings or recommendations. Aim for 200–400 words.

Declaration by Submitter

Start this section on a new page. Replace bracketed items before lodgement and confirm with co-authors that the statement reflects their contribution.

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On behalf of the Protocol Policy Lab

May 17, 2026

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A substantive contribution covers at least one of: (i) conception and design of the submission strategy, (ii) acquisition of evidence requiring significant intellectual judgement or planning, (iii) analysis and interpretation of the evidence, (iv) drafting significant parts of the submission or critically reviewing it.

Present each chapter’s collaborators in a four-column table. Percentages within each column should sum to 100% across all contributors for that area. Ensure the Protocol Policy Lab is the lead contributor for every chapter.

Example. The following contributors shaped **Chapter 3 (Response to the Terms of Reference)**:

	Conceptualisation	Evidence Gathering	Analysis	Writing
Protocol Policy Lab	60%	80%	70%	80%
External reviewer 1	20%	10%	20%	10%
External reviewer 2	20%	10%	10%	10%

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{Name and version}	{e.g., literature scanning, language editing}	{Exact prompts or queries}	{Chapter or section affected}

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Personal information. Do not include personal contact details, residential addresses, or signatures of interview subjects. Submissions tabled by a parliamentary committee become publicly accessible unless an embargo is granted.

Structure. The order below works for most policy submissions: Table of Contents; List of Figures; List of Tables; List of Abbreviations and Notation; main chapters (Introduction, Background, Response to ToR, Evidence and Analysis, Recommendations, Conclusion); Bibliography; Appendices.

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Chapter 1

Abbreviations and Notation

Abbreviations used in this submission

ASQ	Additional Supplementary Question
DC	Data Centre
GWh	Gigawatt hour
NEM	National Electricity Market
PAWC	Parliamentary Accounts and Works Committee
PoP	Point of Presence
PUE	Power Usage Effectiveness
QoN	Question on Notice
ToR	Terms of Reference
WUE	Water Usage Effectiveness

Common quantitative notation

$\mathbb{R}$	set of real numbers
$\mathbb{N}$	set of natural numbers $\{0, 1, \dots\}$
$\mathbb{E}[\cdot]$	expectation
Var	variance
$\sim$	is distributed as
$\propto$	is proportional to
$\approx$	is approximately
$\ll$	is much smaller than
$\ \cdot\ $	Euclidean norm

Chapter 2

Introduction

2.1 Context of the Inquiry

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2.2 Scope of this Submission

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2.3 Structure of the Document

Chapter 3 surveys the policy and technical landscape. Chapter 4 answers each Term of Reference in turn. Chapter 5 presents the evidence base. Chapter 6 sets out the recommendations. The Conclusion summarises and the Appendix supplies supporting material.

Chapter 3

Background

3.1 Data Centres in the Australian Context

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3.2 Regulatory Landscape

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3.3 Prior Inquiries and Reports

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Chapter 4

Response to the Terms of Reference

4.1 ToR 1: Scope and Definitions

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4.2 ToR 2: Economic and Workforce Impact

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4.3 ToR 3: Energy, Water and Land Use

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4.4 ToR 4: Governance, Transparency and Reporting

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4.5 ToR 5: Risk and Resilience

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Chapter 5

Evidence and Analysis

5.1 Data Sources

Primary materials are catalogued in `inquiries/pawc-data-centres/`: the uncorrected transcript of the 1 May 2026 hearing, the supplementary questions issued to Protocol Policy Lab, and the corrections factsheet covering Questions on Notice and Additional Supplementary Questions.

5.2 Method

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5.3 Findings

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Chapter 6

Recommendations

6.1 Recommendation 1

Recommendation. Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit.

Basis. See Section [4.1](#) and Section [5.3](#).

6.2 Recommendation 2

Recommendation. Nam dui ligula, fringilla a, euismod sodales, sollicitudin vel, wisi.

Basis. See Section [4.3](#) and Section [5.3](#).

6.3 Recommendation 3

Recommendation. Nulla malesuada porttitor diam.

Basis. See Section [4.4](#).

Chapter 7

Conclusion

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Appendix A

Supporting Material

A.1 Source Document Index

Transcript (uncorrected) [inquiries/pawc-data-centres/transcript-uncorrected-2026-05-01.pdf](#)

Supplementary Questions [inquiries/pawc-data-centres/supplementary-questions.pdf](#)

Corrections Factsheet [inquiries/pawc-data-centres/factsheet-corrections-2026-05-01.pdf](#)

Draft Response (ToR) [inquiries/pawc-data-centres/draft-response-terms-of-reference.docx](#)

A.2 Glossary

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